

# Project : "Build & Break" Secure Application Pipeline

**85/100 Points**

5/15/2026

Attempt 1



Review Feedback

Offline Score:

**85/100**

View Feedback

Anonymous Grading: **no****Unlimited Attempts Allowed**

4/14/2026 to 5/15/2026

▼ **Details**

## Objective

Students design, build, secure, and attack a containerized / traditional web application (on github) while implementing a full DevSecOps pipeline.

I have 30 Students. 10 Groups, 3 Students per group to be made.

## Scope & Deliverables

- Dockerized environment and / or traditional web app, but it should be on github along with the installation documents, requirements, and manual.
- CI/CD pipeline with:
  - SAST
  - DAST
  - SCA
- Threat model
- Exploitation report
- Final remediation + re-test report
- Executive summary (non-technical audience)

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### What I am expecting in an Application

Let's keep it simple, practical, and—most importantly—working 😊

I expect at least a decent domain-based application with **RBAC (Role-Based Access Control)** properly implemented. There should be an **admin user** and **non-admin users**, each seeing what they are supposed to see (and not accidentally ruling the system).

This means:

- Separate **admin, common, and restricted pages**
- Sensible access control (no "everyone is admin" surprises)

Also, please include a **proper login/logout session mechanism**—not something that logs in once and lives forever like a legend.

**Core Features (these must actually work, not just exist in screenshots)**

At minimum:

- User interaction (forms, inputs—buttons that actually do something)
- Data handling (store + retrieve, not “store and pray”)
- Basic validation (no “name = 123@@@!!!” situations)

**Examples of expected functionality:**

- Login / Signup (or at least a believable user simulation)
  - CRUD operations (Create, Read, Update, Delete—yes, all four, not just Create and disappear)
  - Search / Filter (because scrolling endlessly is not a feature)
  - Clean pages (minimal chaos, maximum clarity)
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**Suggested Structure (a friendly guideline, not a strict prison):**

- Home / Dashboard
- Main Feature Page (your core functionality)
- Login / Register (if applicable)

And finally—**please make sure a database is properly integrated** to save all activities.

If your app forgets everything after refresh... we will too (when grading 😊 )

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## Weekly Plan

**Week 1:**

- Design app + threat model
- Define attack surface

**Week 2:**

- Build app + Dockerize
- Integrate SAST/SCA

**Week 3:**

- Perform DAST + manual pentesting
- Exploit vulnerabilities

**Week 4:**

- Fix issues
- Generate professional report
- Present findings

Due to time constraint, We are allowing for one group to

- Make the App from Security aspect
- Test it from all Security aspects (SAST / DAST / SCA and business logics if applicable.)
- Report it
- Fix it
- all on Github

Ensure that you have to perform your pushes w.r.t guidelines mentioned in [https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/pages/associating-issues-with-your-gitpushes?module\\_item\\_id=186694](https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/pages/associating-issues-with-your-gitpushes?module_item_id=186694) ([https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/pages/associating-issues-with-your-gitpushes?module\\_item\\_id=186694](https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/pages/associating-issues-with-your-gitpushes?module_item_id=186694))

# Project Grading Rubric

| Level 1 • 25%                                                                                    |  | Level 2 • 50%                                                                                   |  | Level 3 • 75%                                                                                  |  | Level 4 • 100%                                                                                   |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Insufficient                                                                                     |  | Developing                                                                                      |  | Proficient                                                                                     |  | Exemplary                                                                                        |  |
| Bare minimum attempted.<br>Largely incomplete or copied.<br>Little evidence of independent work. |  | Core requirements partially met. Surface-level understanding. Notable gaps in depth or quality. |  | Requirements mostly met. Demonstrates solid understanding. Minor gaps or polish issues remain. |  | All requirements fully met. Professional quality. Evidence of initiative and deep understanding. |  |

01

Table of Contents

5 Marks

| 1.25 marks                                                                                                                                                                             | 2.5 marks                                                                                                                                       | 3.75 marks                                                                                                                                                               | 5 marks                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TOC present but missing most sections<br><br>No page numbers or document links<br><br>Copied from a template without customisation<br><br>Section titles do not match document content | Most major sections listed<br><br>No hyperlinks or page references<br><br>Formatting inconsistent or rough<br><br>Subsections partially missing | All major sections present and accurate<br><br>Subsections included and labelled<br><br>Clickable links or page numbers provided<br><br>Consistent formatting throughout | Comprehensive TOC matching document exactly<br><br>All sections, subsections & appendices listed<br><br>Functional navigation links (PDF bookmarks / hyperlinks)<br><br>Numbering consistent with report body<br><br>Updated to reflect final submission |

02

Architecture & Threat Model

5 Marks

| 1.25 marks                                                                           | 2.5 marks                                                                    | 3.75 marks                                                                                            | 5 marks                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Architecture is text-only, no diagram<br><br>Threat model is a generic template copy | Basic architecture diagram present<br><br>Threats listed but not categorised | Clear layered architecture diagram (frontend / backend / DB)<br><br>STRIDE applied to most components | Professional DFD with actors, data flows & trust boundaries<br><br>Full STRIDE applied per component; DREAD / CVSS scored |

|                                                                     |                                                                        |                                                                              |                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No STRIDE or risk methodology applied<br>Attack surface not defined | Partial mention of STRIDE or DREAD<br>Attack surface vaguely described | Trust boundaries identified<br>Attack surface mapped to application features | Threat prioritisation matrix included<br>Attack surface explicitly tied to DAST / pentest scope<br>Threat model updated post-remediation |
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## 03 GitHub Pipeline Implementation

10 Marks

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <p>2.5 marks</p> <p>GitHub repo exists but pipeline is minimal or broken</p> <p>Only one tool (SAST / DAST / SCA) attempted</p> <p>No CI triggers configured correctly</p> <p>Pipeline config file incomplete or template-only</p> | <p>5 marks</p> <p>Pipeline runs at least two of SAST / DAST / SCA</p> <p>Some jobs pass; others fail silently</p> <p>Tools configured with default settings only</p> <p>Reports not archived or inconsistently stored</p> | <p>7.5 marks</p> <p>All three stages (SAST + DAST + SCA) integrated &amp; running</p> <p>Pipeline triggers on push / PR events</p> <p>Reports generated and stored as artifacts</p> <p>App deployment step included</p> | <p>10 marks</p> <p>Full automated pipeline: SAST + DAST + SCA all operational</p> <p>Pipeline fails on critical / high severity findings (quality gate)</p> <p>Separate jobs per stage with clear naming</p> <p>Dockerised app spun up for DAST in CI</p> <p>Remediation branch re-runs pipeline and passes</p> |
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## 04 Vulnerability Discovery Depth

20 Marks

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <p>5 marks</p> <p>Only automated tool output pasted without analysis</p> <p>1–2 findings described superficially</p> <p>No OWASP / CVE references</p> <p>High false-positive rate; no filtering</p> <p>No screenshots or evidence</p> | <p>10 marks</p> <p>Multiple findings from automated tools</p> <p>Basic description of each vulnerability</p> <p>Some OWASP Top 10 mapping attempted</p> <p>Severity ratings mentioned but not justified</p> <p>Screenshots present for some findings</p> | <p>15 marks</p> <p>Good mix of automated + manual findings</p> <p>All findings mapped to OWASP Top 10</p> <p>CVSS scores calculated per finding</p> <p>Screenshots / HTTP request evidence included</p> <p>False positives identified and excluded</p> | <p>20 marks</p> <p>Comprehensive findings: tooling + manual pentesting</p> <p>Business logic flaws identified (e.g. IDOR, broken RBAC)</p> <p>OWASP Top 10 fully mapped with justifications</p> <p>Accurate CVSS v3.1 scores with vector strings</p> <p>Chained / multi-step vulnerabilities demonstrated</p> <p>Minimal false positives; full evidence for each finding</p> |
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## 05 Exploitation Quality

10 Marks

|                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                     |
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| <p>2.5 marks</p> <p>Exploitation claimed but no evidence or PoC</p> <p>Screenshots do not demonstrate impact</p> <p>No reproduction steps provided</p> | <p>5 marks</p> <p>One vulnerability exploited with basic PoC</p> <p>Screenshots show some impact</p> <p>Steps provided but incomplete</p> | <p>7.5 marks</p> <p>Multiple vulnerabilities exploited with clear PoC</p> <p>Step-by-step reproduction steps documented</p> <p>Impact (data leakage, privilege escalation, etc.)</p> | <p>10 marks</p> <p>Professional pentest-quality exploitation</p> <p>Chained exploits (e.g. XSS → session hijack → admin access)</p> |
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|-------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Likely theoretical only | Impact described at surface level | demonstrated<br>Attacker perspective clearly articulated | Business impact quantified (data exposed, accounts compromised)<br><br>Full reproducible PoC with tool / script / payload<br><br>RBAC bypass or logic flaw specifically exploited |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## 06 Remediation Effectiveness

10 Marks

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| <p>2.5 marks</p> <p>Issues acknowledged but no actual code fixes</p> <p>Remediation is generic advice only (e.g. "use HTTPS")</p> <p>No re-test performed</p> <p>Pipeline still failing after "fixes"</p> | <p>5 marks</p> <p>Some code changes visible in GitHub</p> <p>Only low-severity issues fixed</p> <p>Re-test mentioned but not evidenced</p> <p>Root cause not addressed for major findings</p> | <p>7.5 marks</p> <p>Most critical / high findings remediated with code commits</p> <p>Re-test screenshots / pipeline output provided</p> <p>Explanation of fix methodology included</p> <p>Some regression considerations noted</p> | <p>10 marks</p> <p>All critical &amp; high findings remediated at root cause level</p> <p>Pipeline re-run after fixes — now passes quality gates</p> <p>Re-test confirms fix effectiveness for each finding</p> <p>Regression checks or unit tests added</p> <p>Remaining low/informational risks formally accepted with rationale</p> |
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## 07 Report Quality

5 Marks

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| <p>1.25 marks</p> <p>Poorly structured; major sections missing</p> <p>Grammar and spelling errors throughout</p> <p>No executive summary</p> <p>Inconsistent formatting and fonts</p> | <p>2.5 marks</p> <p>Basic structure present and readable</p> <p>Executive summary included but very technical</p> <p>Inconsistent formatting in places</p> <p>Some findings lack supporting evidence</p> | <p>3.75 marks</p> <p>Well-structured with clear section flow</p> <p>Executive summary readable by non-technical audience</p> <p>Consistent formatting and professional language</p> <p>Charts / tables used to organise findings</p> | <p>5 marks</p> <p>Professional pentest-report quality throughout</p> <p>Executive summary: risk summary, business impact, recommendations</p> <p>Findings table with severity, CVSS, status columns</p> <p>Annexes include raw tool output &amp; screenshots</p> <p>Proofreading clearly performed; zero grammar issues</p> |
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## 08 GitHub Issues, Pushes &amp; Updates

5 Marks

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| <p>1.25 marks</p> <p>Fewer than 5 total commits across 4 weeks</p> <p>No GitHub Issues created</p> <p>No branching strategy used</p> | <p>2.5 marks</p> <p>Some regular commits with basic messages</p> <p>A few issues created but not linked to commits</p> | <p>3.75 marks</p> <p>Good commit history across all 4 weeks</p> <p>Issues linked in push messages as per course guideline</p> | <p>5 marks</p> <p>Exemplary commit history — active across all 4 weeks</p> <p>All pushes follow the course issue-association guideline</p> |
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| Push messages are blank or meaningless (e.g. "update") | Basic branch usage (main only or one feature branch)<br><br>Activity clustered near deadline | Feature / fix branches used per task<br><br>Meaningful commit messages describing changes | Issues closed via commit references (fixes #N)<br><br>Milestones / labels used to track weekly sprints<br><br>Pull requests used for merging with review comments |
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## 09 Member Contributions &amp; GitHub Profiles

5 Marks

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| <p>1.25 marks</p> <p>One member made all commits; others absent</p> <p>No role differentiation visible in history</p> <p>GitHub profiles of 2 members show zero contributions</p> <p>No README stating who did what</p> | <p>2.5 marks</p> <p>2 of 3 members have some commits</p> <p>Contributions highly uneven</p> <p>Roles mentioned in README but not reflected in history</p> <p>Third member's work not verifiable</p> | <p>3.75 marks</p> <p>All 3 members have meaningful commits</p> <p>Rough role split visible (e.g. app dev / security / report)</p> <p>README or wiki documents individual contributions</p> <p>Contribution graph shows distributed activity</p> | <p>5 marks</p> <p>All 3 members with significant, balanced contributions</p> <p>Clear roles documented: each member owns identifiable deliverables</p> <p>Commit messages identify individual responsibility areas</p> <p>Viva confirms individual knowledge matching their commit area</p> <p>GitHub Insights / contributor graph verifies distributed work</p> |
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## 10 Presentation &amp; Live Demo

25 Marks

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| <p>6.25 marks</p> <p>Unable to run a live demo or app is broken</p> <p>Only one member speaks; others silent</p> <p>Reads directly from slides or report</p> <p>Unable to answer basic Q&amp;A on own work</p> <p>No security findings demonstrated live</p> | <p>12.5 marks</p> <p>Basic demo runs with some features shown</p> <p>Surface-level explanation of SAST/DAST/SCA results</p> <p>Some questions answered correctly</p> <p>Executive summary presented but remains technical</p> <p>Two members contribute to presentation</p> | <p>18.75 marks</p> <p>Smooth live demo — all core features and RBAC shown</p> <p>Security findings clearly explained with evidence</p> <p>All three members present different sections</p> <p>Most Q&amp;A questions handled confidently</p> <p>Pipeline shown running live or with recorded output. Demo to be on HTTPS either on Self signed and or actual https cert</p> | <p>25 marks</p> <p>Professional, confident presentation by all 3 members</p> <p>Live demo: full app + live attack demonstration + fix proof</p> <p>Pipeline shown triggering SAST/DAST/SCA in CI</p> <p>Executive summary delivered in plain language (non-technical test)</p> <p>All Q&amp;A answered; each member demonstrates their specific work</p> <p>Time well managed; delivery polished and confident. Demo to be on HTTPS either on Self signed and or actual https cert</p> |
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### Individual vs Group Split

**70% Group Mark** — Based on the quality of the shared GitHub repository, report, pipeline, and findings. All group members receive the same base score for criteria 01–09.

**30% Viva Mark** — Assessed individually during the live presentation. Each member must demonstrate understanding of their own contribution area. Criterion 10 (Presentation, 25 marks) feeds directly into this split.

A member who cannot answer questions about their own commits or report section may receive a reduced individual mark even if the group work is excellent.

### AI Usage Policy

Students are permitted to use AI tools (Claude, GPT, etc.) to assist with development and tooling. However, the expectation is that:

**All findings must be understood.** During viva, students must explain why a vulnerability exists, how the exploit works, and why the fix resolves the root cause — not just read AI-generated text.

**All code must be their own responsibility.** AI-assisted code with unexplained security flaws that were not discovered or reported will be treated as a gap in vulnerability discovery depth.

### GitHub Push Guideline

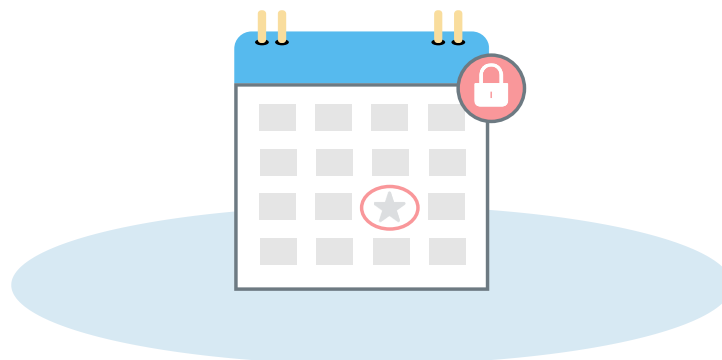
All pushes must follow the issue-association format specified at the course Canvas page. Commits without linked issues **will not count** toward criterion 08 (GitHub Issues, Pushes & Updates).

Format: `fix #12: sanitise SQL input in login form`

Each push should map to an open issue that was created in advance of the work, not retroactively.

### Application Baseline Requirements

- The application must include be running on **IP Address / Hostname, with HTTPS, NOT Localhost**,
- working **RBAC** (admin + non-admin roles), a proper **session mechanism** (login/logout),
- full **CRUD operations**,
- a connected **database**, and
- basic **input validation**.
- Course Learning to be implemented in Project.
- Groups whose application does not meet this baseline will be capped at **Level 2** for criteria 04, 05, and 06, regardless of report quality.



## Availability Dates

4/14/2026 to 5/15/2026



<https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/modules/items/187994>

<https://hulms.instructure.com/courses/4979/modu>

*You are unable to submit to this assignment as your enrollment in this course has been concluded.*